staple staple

MY ENGLISH TOOLKIT

See the time. Build the sentence.

A flip book for 7 verb tenses

An event
at a point in time

A routine
again and again

In progress
in the middle of it

Connected to now
before now + now

What do you want to say?

Usually / a fact	1 **Present simple**	Happening now	4 **Present continuous**
Finished in the past	2 **Past simple**	In progress in the past	5 **Past continuous**
A prediction or promise	3 **Future simple**	In progress in the future	6 **Future continuous**
Before now, connected to now			7 **Present perfect**

Know your verb forms

V1 · base	**V1-s · he / she / it**	**V-ing**	**V2 · past**	**V3 · past participle**
work / eat	works / eats	working / eating	worked / ate	worked / eaten

Name: _____

Time clues help. Meaning comes first.

Cut between cards. Cut off the striped parts. Stack cover, then 1–7. Staple at the top.

✂ cut

✂ cut off

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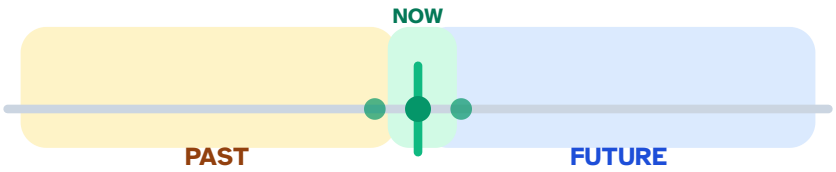
1. Present simple

MEANING: Habits, routines, and facts.

Helpful time clues: every day · usually · always · on Mondays

Draw when: I eat breakfast every day.

Timeline
Draw the stamp.
Explain it.



	+ Affirmative	− Negative	? Question
Formula	subject + **V1**	subject + **don't** + **V1**	**Do** + subject + **V1**?
Regular e.g. work · worked	I **work** at a hotel.	I **don't work** on Sunday.	**Do** you **work** on Sunday?
Irregular e.g. eat · ate · eaten	I **eat** breakfast at 7.	I **don't eat** meat.	**Do** you **eat** meat?

he / she / it: She **works**. · She **doesn't work**. · **Does** she **work**?

My sentence: _____

Watch out! For this action: ~~I am work.~~ → I work.

Present simple

✂ ✂ ✂ ✂ ✂ ✂

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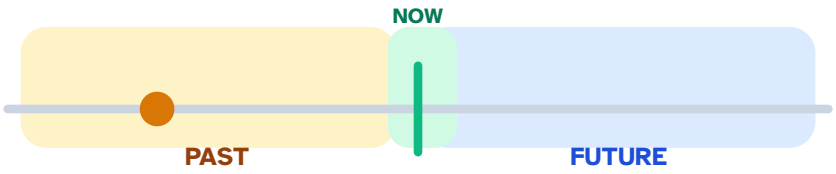
2. Past simple

MEANING: Finished actions in the past.

Helpful time clues: yesterday · last week · 2 days ago · in 2020

Draw when: I ate breakfast yesterday.

Timeline
Draw the stamp.
Explain it.



	+ Affirmative	− Negative	? Question
Formula	subject + **V2**	subject + **didn't** + **V1**	**Did** + subject + **V1**?
Regular e.g. work · worked	I **worked** yesterday.	I **didn't work** yesterday.	**Did** you **work** yesterday?
Irregular e.g. eat · ate · eaten	I **ate** breakfast.	I **didn't eat** breakfast.	**Did** you **eat** breakfast?

My sentence:

Watch out! After did, use V1: ~~Did you went?~~ → Did you go?

✂ cut

Past simple

staple staple

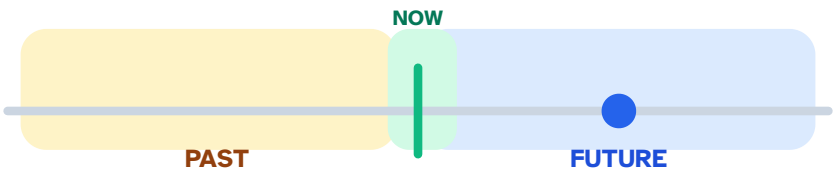
3. Future simple

MEANING: Predictions, promises, and decisions made now.

Helpful time clues: tomorrow · next week · later · soon

Draw when: I will eat breakfast tomorrow.

Timeline
Draw the stamp.
Explain it.



	+ Affirmative	− Negative	? Question
Formula	subject + **will** + **V1**	subject + **won't** + **V1**	**Will** + subject + **V1**?
Regular e.g. work · worked	I **will work** tomorrow.	I **won't work** tomorrow.	**Will** you **work** tomorrow?
Irregular e.g. eat · ate · eaten	I **will eat** later.	I **won't eat** later.	**Will** you **eat** later?

My sentence:

Watch out! No -s after will: ~~She will works.~~ → She will work.

Future simple

staple staple

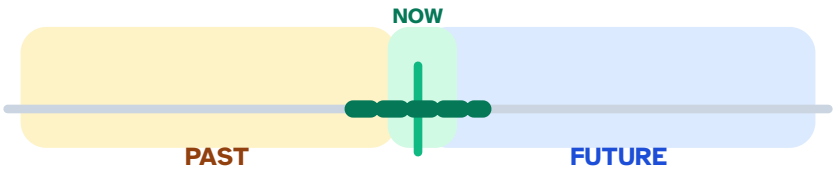
4. Present continuous

MEANING: Happening right now. In the middle of the action.

Helpful time clues: now · right now · today · at the moment

Draw when: I am eating breakfast now.

Timeline
Draw the stamp.
Explain it.



	+ Affirmative	− Negative	? Question
Formula	subject + **am** / **is** / **are** + **V-ing**	subject + **am** / **is** / **are** + **not** + **V-ing**	**Am** / **Is** / **Are** + subject + **V-ing**?
Regular e.g. work · worked	I **am working** now.	I **am not working** now.	**Are** you **working** now?
Irregular e.g. eat · ate · eaten	I **am eating** now.	I **am not eating** now.	**Are** you **eating** now?

My sentence:

Watch out! Don't forget am / is / are: ~~I working.~~ → I am working.

✂ cut

Present continuous

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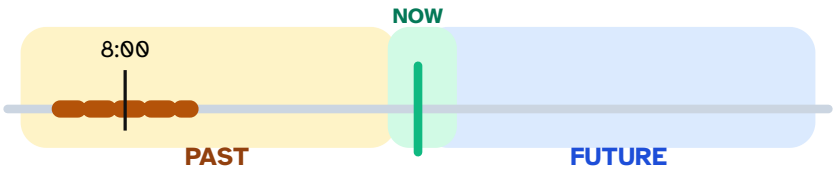
5. Past continuous

MEANING: In the middle of an action in the past.

Helpful time clues: at 8:00 last night · when you called · all day yesterday

Draw when: I was eating at 8:00 last night.

Timeline
Draw the stamp.
Explain it.



	+ Affirmative	− Negative	? Question
Formula	subject + **was** / **were** + **V-ing**	subject + **wasn't** / **weren't** + **V-ing**	**Was** / **Were** + subject + **V-ing**?
Regular e.g. work · worked	I **was working** at 8:00.	I **wasn't working** at 8:00.	**Were** you **working** at 8:00?
Irregular e.g. eat · ate · eaten	I **was eating** at 8:00.	I **wasn't eating** at 8:00.	**Were** you **eating** at 8:00?

My sentence:

Watch out! I / he / she / it + was · you / we / they + were

Past continuous

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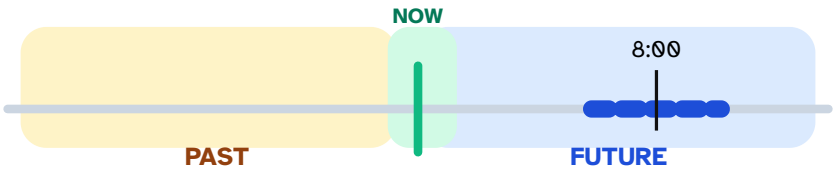
6. Future continuous

MEANING: In the middle of an action in the future.

Helpful time clues: at 8:00 tomorrow · this time next week · all day tomorrow

Draw when: I will be eating at 8:00 tomorrow.

Timeline
Draw the stamp.
Explain it.



	+ Affirmative	− Negative	? Question
Formula	subject + **will be** + **V-ing**	subject + **won't be** + **V-ing**	**Will** + subject + **be** + **V-ing**?
Regular e.g. work · worked	I **will be working** at 8:00.	I **won't be working** at 8:00.	**Will** you **be working** at 8:00?
Irregular e.g. eat · ate · eaten	I **will be eating** at 8:00.	I **won't be eating** at 8:00.	**Will** you **be eating** at 8:00?

My sentence:

Watch out! Don't forget be: ~~I will working.~~ → I will be working.

✂ cut

Future continuous

staple staple

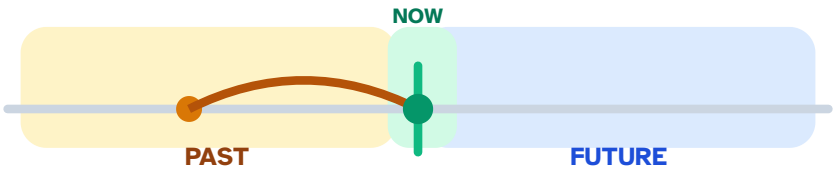
7. Present perfect

MEANING: Before now, connected to now.

Helpful time clues: ever · never · already · for 3 years · since 2023

Draw when: I have eaten sushi before. The exact time is not given.

Timeline
Draw the stamp.
Explain it.



Experience: I have eaten sushi. **Still true:** I have worked here for three years.

	+ Affirmative	− Negative	? Question
Formula	subject + **have** / **has** + **V3**	subject + **haven't** / **hasn't** + **V3**	**Have** / **Has** + subject + **V3**?
Regular e.g. work · worked	I **have worked** at night.	I **haven't worked** at night.	**Have** you ever **worked** at night?
Irregular e.g. eat · ate · eaten	I **have eaten** sushi.	I **haven't eaten** sushi.	**Have** you ever **eaten** sushi?

he / she / it: She **has worked**. · She **hasn't worked**. · **Has** she **worked**?

My sentence:

Watch out! Use V3, not V2: ~~I have ate.~~ → I have eaten.

Present perfect